

Class 10th | English



Footprints Without Feet

THE MAKING OF A SCIENTIST

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. How did Ebright's mother help him in becoming a scientist?

Ans. Richard Ebright's mother helped him in becoming a scientist by encouraging his interest in learning. She took him on trips and bought scientific equipment for him. She spent all her time in setting up challenges for him. This helped Richard learn a lot. She presented him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X', the book that changed Richard's life forever.

QUESTIONS

2. What lesson does Ebright learn when he does not win anything at a science fair?

Ans. When Ebright entered the county science fair, he learnt what science was all about. He learnt that science was not a neat and tidy display of tissues on a slide. It was about the real experiments that were performed to get some real results.

QUESTIONS

3. Hobbies play a very important role in one's life.
Elaborate this with reference to 'The Making of a Scientist'.

Ans. It is true that hobbies play a very important role in one's life. It was Richard Ebright's hobbies that led him into the field of science. His hobbies were encouraged by his mother who always motivated him to learn new things. Further, it is because of his hobbies that he became a curious all rounder, always ready to participate in things that he loved to do.

QUESTIONS

4. Why did Richard lose interest in tagging butterflies?

Ans. Richard raised thousands of butterflies, tagged them and released them to study their migration. But soon, he lost interest because only two of his tagged butterflies were recaptured and they had travelled only seventy-five miles.

QUESTIONS

5. Richard's project on the purpose of the twelve tiny gold spots on a monarch pupa was highly valuable in two ways. List the two ways.

Ans. Richard's project on the purpose of the twelve tiny gold spots on a monarch pupa was highly valuable in the following two ways.

- (i) First, he discovered a hormone that was necessary for the growth of the pupa.
- (ii) Second, he got a chance to work at a famous laboratory as he won the first prize in the county fair and entry into the International Science and Engineering Fair.

QUESTIONS

6. What opinion did Mr. Weiherer, Ebright's social science teacher have about him?

Ans. Mr. Weiherer was Ebright's social studies teacher and the advisor to the clubs that Richard Ebright had joined. He praised him for his brilliant mind, his curiosity and a will to win for the right reason. He also admired Richard for his spirit to do his best all the time.

QUESTIONS

7. What are the essential qualities for becoming a scientist, according to Ebright's teacher?

Ans. According to Ebright's teacher, the essential qualities of becoming a scientist are to have a first rate mind, scientific curiosity and a will to win for the right reasons. In addition to that, a person should have the zeal to excel for the sake of doing the best job.

QUESTIONS

8. Suggest two ways through which you feel scientific temperament can be developed in a child.

Ans. Scientific temperament is all about questioning. It can be developed in a child in the following ways

- By encouraging him/her to ask questions rather than making him/her accept something blindly.
- Logical thinking is another way to develop scientific temperament in children.

QUESTIONS

9. Validate the importance of small, fun learning tasks towards successful careers, in the context of Richard Ebright in 'The Making of Scientist'

Ans. By reading about Richard Ebright in 'The Making of a Scientist', the readers can understand the importance of small, fun learning tasks because even though he started collecting and breeding butterflies just for fun, he later became curious about the gold spots. This fun activity finally helped him build a career as a well renowned scientist, after being able to discover a theory of cell structure and later DNA.

QUESTIONS

10. Mention any two of Ebright's contributions to the world of science.

Ans. The two contributions of Ebright to the world of science were

- (i) Ebright built a device that showed that the spots on monarch butterflies wings produce a hormone that is necessary for the growth of the butterfly.
- (ii) His other important contribution was his study of how cells read their DNA.

QUESTIONS

- 11.** "Richie was my whole life after his father died." said Richard's mother.
Describe Richard Ebright's relationship with his mother.

Ans. Richard Ebright was in third grade when his father died. Since then, Richard became the sole focus of his mother's life. His mother was her only friend till he started school her mother used to find things for him to do not physical work but stuff to learn. She used to take him on trips and bought him microscope, telescope, camera and mounting material. It was his mother's focus and attention to his hobbies that Richard became a successful scientist. Thus, the relationship between Richard and his mother were based on trust, love, friendship and companionship.

QUESTIONS

12. Discuss the role of Ebright's mother in making him a scientist.

Ans. Richard's mother played a huge role in making him a great scientist. Ebright was a single child. After his father died, his mother made him the focus of her life. She would buy him all kinds of microscopes, telescopes and other equipments. After dinner, she gave him problems to solve. This helped Richard to learn a lot. She always tried to give him work that required no physical labour but those which enhanced his learning skill. It was his mother who got him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X'. This book opened the world of science for Richard. She also wrote to Dr. Urquhart to guide her son. The scientist helped Richard and guided him. Thus, his mother shaped him into an extraordinary scientist.

QUESTIONS

13. Give a brief character sketch of Ebright's mother.

Ans. Richard H Ebright's mother was a gentle and kind lady who encouraged and inspired Ebright's interest in learning. It was she who laid the foundation of his success as a scientist.

After her husband's death, her son, who was studying in the third grade, became her life. She encouraged her son's keen interest in learning. She understood that her son had a curious and a bright mind. She recognised her son's scientific temper, so she made sure that her son had everything that he needed. She took him on trips and bought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras, mounting material and all other equipments.

She was his only companion before Richard started going to school. When Richard's school started it was she who encouraged him to make friends. She would invite his friends to their house and she would sit with him at night.

QUESTIONS

Even when Richard did not have any work to do, his mother made sure that she found something to engage her son. It was she who got him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X' and opened the world of science for him.

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